

AI-ready data starts with a named decision

Gartner forecasts that through 2026, organisations will abandon **60%** of AI projects that aren't supported by AI-ready data. And **63%** of data leaders aren't sure their own practices are ready. The fix starts with one sentence: the decision the data has to support.

THE GARTNER NUMBERS one forecast, one survey

60%
of AI projects unsupported by AI-ready data – Gartner's forecast, through 2026

63%
of data leaders don't have, or aren't sure they have, AI-ready practices

Gartner, "Lack of AI-Ready Data Puts AI Projects at Risk" (26 Feb 2025). 63% from Gartner's Q3 2024 survey of 248 data management leaders. The 60% is a forecast that nobody will confirm with a scorecard, so lean on the reasoning behind it.

CLEAN VS AI-READY two different tests

CLEAN DATA ASKS
Accurate. Governed. Available.

AI-READY DATA ASKS
Fit for one named decision, made on repeat, with nobody checking each time.

Data can pass every audit and still fail this, because nobody named the decision first.

NAME IT BEFORE YOU AUTOMATE IT the naming test

1 Name the decision
One sentence about one decision.
– "It helps with renewals" is too vague. Say which account, which queue, which call, and how often.

2 Name the fields
The two or three it actually depends on.
– Only what this one decision reads, out of your whole catalogue.

3 Check those fields
For the records that matter, today.
– Populated, current, and the same answer in every system that holds them.

Can't finish step one? Then the first job is naming the decision, before any data work.

WHERE THIS SITS five layers, this one lit

I GOVERNANCE

2 CLEAN DATA

3 STANDARDIZED PROCESSES

4 CONTROLS

5 OPERATING MODEL

Monday morning ONE SENTENCE, ONE AFTERNOON

Take the one AI use case you actually care about and write, in one sentence, the specific decision it makes, repeatedly, with nobody checking each time.

Then list the two or three fields that decision depends on, and check those specific fields. Can't finish the sentence? That's the finding.

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"AI-ready data is not clean data. It is data that is ready for a decision you can name."

"Your AI maturity will never exceed your operational maturity."

Free

Score your own data – the AI-Ready Operations Assessment runs the naming test on your systems. vihrenlabs.gumroad.com/l/rmkje